

LESSON 21

Stop Just Reading the Bible, Study It This Way Instead

8: Studying the Bible

Executive Summary

Careful Bible study moves beyond passive reading by asking three disciplined questions: What does the text say? What does it mean in its original context? How should its truth shape belief and obedience? Like the Bereans in Acts 17, believers should examine Scripture attentively and test every claim by God's Word. Patient observation protects interpretation, and faithful interpretation leads to responsible application.

Key Terms

Observation	Carefully noticing the words, structure, details, and relationships present in a biblical passage.
Interpretation	The disciplined work of understanding what Scripture means before applying it to life.
Application	Responding to the true meaning of Scripture with concrete belief, repentance, obedience, or worship.
Context	The literary, historical, grammatical, and cultural setting that helps reveal a passage's intended meaning.

Key Verses

English Standard Version (ESV)

2 Timothy 2:15

15 Do your best to present yourself to God as one approved, a worker who has no need to be ashamed, rightly handling the word of truth.

Acts 17:11

11 Now these Jews were more noble than those in Thessalonica; they received the word with all eagerness, examining the Scriptures daily to see if these things were so.

Application Questions

1. Read 2 Timothy 2:15 and Acts 17:11. What belief, attitude, or action do these verses call you to embrace?

2. Which key term most clarifies your understanding of observation, interpretation, and application, and why?

3. Where does the truth about observation, interpretation, and application confront a current assumption, habit, fear, temptation, or responsibility in your life?

4. What specific step of faith or obedience will you take this week, and who can help you follow through?
